

Lesson 12

Negotiation Tactics in Action



Warm-Up

1. Talk about a time when you had to negotiate with someone.

- What kind of strategies did you use during the negotiation?
- What was the outcome?
- Please describe your experience.

2. What are the major differences between Western and Japanese culture?

- How do these cultural differences influence negotiation styles?
- How might these differences affect your negotiations with people from those cultures?



Role-Play

Scenario 1: Flexible Hours

Emma: Thanks for meeting. I'd like to **discuss a flexible schedule**. I'm meeting deadlines, and I think starting at 8 a.m. and finishing by 4 p.m. would help me focus better.

Manager: I see. But we need someone available until 5 on Wednesdays for team calls.

Emma: I understand. **How about** I stay until 5 on Wednesdays and adjust my start time that day?

Manager: That's fair. **Let's try it for a month** and see how it goes.

Emma: Great! **Thank you for considering this.**

Discussion Questions:

1. How did Emma build a good tone at the beginning of the conversation?
2. Did Emma understand the manager's concerns? How can you tell?
3. What solution did she offer? Was it fair to both sides?
4. Why do you think the manager agreed in the end?
5. What phrases helped keep the conversation positive?

Scenario 2: Discount

Mark: We plan to buy 50 licenses. **Can we get a discount?**

Vendor: Our prices are already competitive. **I'm afraid we can't reduce them.**

Mark: Another supplier gave a better offer. I expected more flexibility.

Vendor: If price is your main concern, maybe you should go with them.

Mark: That's not helpful. I hoped we could **find a middle ground.**

Vendor: This is our final price.

Discussion Questions:

1. How did Mark try to persuade the vendor? Was it effective?
2. Was there any effort to explore options or ask questions?
3. What could either side have done differently to reach an agreement?
4. What language made the conversation difficult?



Negotiation Tactics

Study the following tactics to make a successful negotiation.

Tactic	Description
Build rapport	Start with small talk and show understanding
Active listening	Pay close attention to what the other party is saying.
Research and prepare	Gather all relevant information. Know your goals, the other party's potential interests, and any alternatives.
Ask open-ended questions	Gather more information: <i>"What are your priorities for this deal?"</i>
BATNA (Best Alternative)	Know your best backup option if the deal fails: <i>"Would a trial leadership period work?"</i>
Silence as a tool	Use pauses to create space and prompt the other party to speak or reconsider
Label objections	Name the concern to reduce resistance: <i>"It sounds like you're worried about..."</i>
Mirroring	Repeat key words to show you're listening and encourage them to explain more
Anchoring	Start with your strongest acceptable position to frame the negotiation
Conditional offers	Link requests with concessions: <i>"If we extend the deadline, could you reduce the price?"</i>
Win-win approach	Aim for solutions that benefit both parties.



Production

HANDLING OBJECTIONS IN THE WORKPLACE

Instructions:

1. **Work in pairs.**
 - **Role A: The Speaker (Responder)**
You are the person receiving the objection. Your task is to listen carefully, remain calm, and use negotiation tactics to respond effectively and professionally.
 - **Role B: The Objector**
You present the objection from the scenario. Read the objection line clearly, using a natural and professional tone. You can improvise slightly if needed to make it more conversational.
2. **Read the scenario carefully.**
3. **Choose 1–2 negotiation tactics to respond with.**

Use professional, polite, and assertive language. Try to include some key phrases you've learned (e.g., "How about we meet halfway?", "I understand your concern...", "We're willing to consider...").

4. **Switch roles and try a new scenario.**
5. **Tip:** If you're in a group of 3, the third person can act as a **Coach/Observer**, noting which tactics were used and giving short feedback at the end.

Scenarios

SCENARIO 1: Promotion Objection – *Internal Workplace Negotiation*

Context:

A: You've been with the company for over a year and are now applying for a **Team Leader position**. You've taken on extra responsibilities and completed several team projects. You're having a one-on-one meeting with your manager to discuss your application.

B (Manager): During the meeting, you raise concerns:

“I don’t think you’re ready to lead a team yet. You haven’t managed any large projects, and your communication needs improvement.”

A - Responses:

SCENARIO 2: Client Objection – *Price Negotiation*

Context:

A: You are a **sales representative** from a software company. You’re meeting with a potential client who is interested in your CRM tool. You’ve just given your pitch, and now you’re discussing the price.

B (Client): compare the price with A’s competitors:

“That’s too expensive. We’ve seen similar tools for 20% less from another provider.”

A – Responses:

Debrief Questions (after each role-play):

- Was the objection handled effectively?
- Which tactics were used, and how did they help?
- What could have made the response more persuasive or collaborative?